BEFORE YOU READ

Two ways to classify a fraction

Fractions are classified either by how the numerator compares with the denominator, or by their structure.

- L0 **Types of fractions**
  - L1 **By numerator and denominator**
    - L2 **Proper** numerator < denominator; value < 1 — $2/5$
    - L2 **Improper** numerator ≥ denominator; value ≥ 1 — $5/3$
    - L2 **Unit** numerator = 1 — $1/7$
  - L1 **By structure**
    - L2 **Mixed number** whole number plus a proper fraction — $2\frac{3}{4}$
    - L2 **Equivalent** same value, scaled — $1/2 = 2/4$
    - L2 **Complex** a fraction inside the numerator or denominator

TAKEAWAY

One fraction, several labels

The two classifications overlap: a unit fraction is also proper, and an improper fraction can be rewritten as a mixed number.